

A Red, Red Rose

• Summary of a poem

↳ The speaker of this poem expresses his intense, deep, passionate love for his beloved. In the first stanza, he admires the beauty and melodious voice of his mistress. He says that she is as beautiful as the rose bloomed in the month of June and her voice is like the melodious music that is sweetly played in tune.

In the second stanza, the speaker confesses that he is in love with the lady as beautiful as she is. He also promises that he will keep loving her until all the oceans in this world get dried.

In the third stanza, the speaker reassures his beloved through his love. He confesses that he will keep loving her until all the rocks melt with the sun and until there will be sand of life running inside him.

At the end he bids farewell to his beloved and promises to come back to her even if he reaches 10,000 miles away. This poem is a confession of the speaker of his love for his beloved at the time of separation.

• Simile

→ Simile is a literary device characterized by the comparison of two things using 'as' and 'like'

e.g. - "My love is like a red red rose" and "My love is like a melody" are similes in the poem.

• Symbolism

→ In the poem Red Red Rose

- Rose is a symbol of love and beauty
 - Music is a symbol of Harmonious relationship.
 - Sands of life symbolises the life of speaker.
 - Seas going dry or Rocks melting with sun symbolises end of the world.
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• Alliteration

→ The literary device characterized by the use of two consecutive words in a line of poem that begin with same consonant sound.

e.g. - Red, Red Rose

• Assonance

→ The literary device characterized by two or more words in a line of poetry that share the same vowel sound is Assonance.

e.g: Will and still
: thee and weel
: My and like

• Hyperbole

↳ Hyperbole is a literary device characterized by the exaggeration of things.

↳ Seas gang dry and the rock melt with the sun are example of Hyperbole

• Refrain

↳ Refrain is a literary device characterized by the repetition of a line at a distance in a piece of poetry.

e.g: I will love thee still, my dear
: The seas gang dry.

• Understanding the Text:

a) What does the speaker compare his love in the first stanza?

Ans. The speaker of this poem expresses his intense, deep and passionate love for his beloved. In the first stanza he admires the beauty and melodious voice of his mistress. He says that she is as beautiful as the rose bloomed in the month of June and her voice is like the melodious music that is sweetly played in the tune. He expr-

esses his intensity of love and admires her beauty in the romantic way.

b) What does the speaker promises in the second and third stanza?

Ans. In the second stanza, the speaker confesses that he is in love with the lady as beautiful as she is. He also promises that he will keep loving her until all the oceans in the world get dried. In the third stanza, the speaker reassures his beloved through his love. He confess that he will keep loving her until all the rocks melt with the ~~sun~~ sun and until there will be sand of life running inside him. He confesses his deep and passionate love very vividly.

c) What imagery does he use in his promise and why do you think he uses such language?

Ans. He uses hyperbolic imagery in his promises and express his love for his beloved in an exaggerating ways. The imagery used like dry sea, melted rocks, are all hyperbolic through which he has promised to love his beloved forever outlasting human life itself. I think he uses such language

to express his profound and genuine love that is constant and eternal. He deeply and passionately loved her mistress and he expresses those love in such ways and uses such language.

d) In the last stanza, what event is about to happen by mention the number of miles?

Ans ^{2.} In the last stanza, where the number of miles is mentioned, we can assume that the partners are going to have a temporary separation as one is going somewhere thousand miles away. Even so, the speaker assumes his lover not to worry and that he will come back to her and that his love for her will not exhaust despite being separated.

e) Which image in the poem do you find the most memorable or surprising and why?

Ans ^{2.} The most memorable image in 'A Red, Red Rose' is the comparison of love to a freshly blooming red rose. This image is powerful because it shows love as beautiful, fresh, and full of life. The bright red color symbolizes deep passion

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and strong emotion, making the feeling of love more vivid and real. It is also surprising how the poet uses such a simple natural image to express such deep and everlasting love.

• Reference to the context

a) What can you infer about the speaker's devotion to his beloved from the following lines?

Ans. From these lines, we can infer that the speaker is deeply devoted to his beloved. He promises to return to her even if he has to travel a very long distance. This shows that physical distance cannot weaken his love. ~~or~~ €

The phrase "ten thousand mile" suggests that he will come back one day for her, when it comes to love. His devotion is not temporary or shallow; it is firm and determined. He wants to reassure his beloved that this separation is not permanent.

These lines tell us that the speaker is loyal and faithful. He wants his beloved to feel safe and sure about his love. His promise shows that his love is not just words but a lifelong commitment.

b) What is the theme of the poem?

Ans The main theme of the poem is true and everlasting love. The poet talks about a love that is very deep, pure, and honest. He shows that real love never fades with time or distance.

Another important theme is loyalty and promise. The poet promises that he will love his beloved forever, even when they are far apart. This shows that real love does not change with time or distance.

The poem also includes the theme of separation and hope. Although the speaker has to leave his beloved for some time, he gives her hope by promising to return. The poem teaches us that true love is patient, faithful, and strong. It shows that love can last forever if it is honest and pure.

c) Paraphrase the whole poem into simple prose form.

Ans The poet says that he loves a young woman very deeply and truly. He compares his love to a red rose that has just bloomed, showing that his love is fresh and beautiful. He also compares it to a sweet song that sounds pleasant to the ears.

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The poet says that even if they are separated for a long time, his love for her will never end. He promises to love her until the seas ~~of the~~ dry up and the rocks melt in the heat of the sun. This means he wants to say that his love will last forever.

At the end of the poem, he says goodbye to his beloved for now. However, he promises that he will return to her. He says that even if he has to travel ten thousand miles, he will come back. This shows his strong hope, loyalty and true love.

Q. Literary devices are tools that enable the writers to present their ideas, emotions, and feelings and also help the readers understand those more profound meanings. Analyse the poem in terms of the literary device such as simile, symbolism, imagery, alliteration, and assonance.

Ans. The poet uses different literary devices to make the poem more beautiful and meaningful. He uses simile when he compares his love to a "red, red rose" and to a "melodie that's sweetly played in tune." This helps us understand how beautiful and pleasant his love is.

He uses symbolism when the rose is used to stand for deep love and passion. Imagery is used when the poet talks about dry seas, and melting rocks, helping us imagine strong pictures in our mind.

Alliteration is seen in the repeated 'r' sound in "red, red rose." This gives a musical effect to the line. ~~Sim~~ Assonance is used through the repetition of vowel sounds in phrases like "My and like" which makes the poem sound soft and smooth. These devices make the poem emotional and enjoyable to read.

e) What is hyperbole? Explain its purpose citing examples of hyperbole used in the poem.

Ans. Hyperbole is a literary device characterized by the exaggeration of things to express strong feelings or emotions. It is ~~not meant to be~~ used to make the idea more powerful and clear.

In the poem, the poet uses hyperbole in lines like "Till all the seas gang dry" and "The rocks melt with the sun." These events cannot happen in real life. Seas cannot dry completely,

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and rocks cannot melt under the sun easily. The poet uses these exaggerated ideas to show that his love has no limit.

The purpose of hyperbole in the poem is to show how deep and endless his love is. It helps the reader feel the strength of his emotions. By using exaggeration, the poet makes his love seem eternal and unforgettable.

f) What is refrain? Why is it used in the poem? Explain citing an example from the poem?

Ans. A refrain is a ~~too~~ line or group of lines in a poem that is repeated at different places, usually at the end of a stanza. It helps to emphasize the main idea of the poem, adds rhythm and music to it and to highlight the certain idea.

In the poem "A Red, Red Rose," the line "I will love thee still, my dear" acts like a refrain. It is repeated to show the speaker's strong and lasting love for his beloved. Similarly "The seas gang dry" also ~~act~~ acts as refrain to describe that he will love his beloved until all the seas go dry.

The refrain is used in the poem to remind

the reader again and again of the poet's promise. It makes the poem easier to remember and more emotional. It also strengthens the message that the speaker's love will never change, no matter what happens.

• Reference beyond the text

Q What kind of love is expressed in "A Red, Red Rose"?

Ans. The poem "A Red, Red Rose" expresses a pure, deep, and everlasting kind of love. The poet's love is not temporary or shallow. It is strong, honest and full of devotion. He compares his love to a fresh red rose, which shows beauty, freshness, and passion. This kind of love is based on loyalty and commitment, not just physical attraction.

The poet promises that his love will last until impossible things happen - like the seas drying up and rocks melting in the sun. This shows that he believes his love is eternal and powerful. Even when he has to leave his beloved, he promises to return, no matter how far the distance is. This shows that his love is faithful and true.

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The love in the poem is romantic, emotional and spiritual. It celebrates love as something beautiful, pure and everlasting.

b) Do you think that love has power? Why do the poets compose poem addressing their beloved?

Ans Yes, love has great power. Love can change a person's life in positive ways. It can make people kind, patient, and hopeful. When people are in love, they feel stronger and more confident. Love helps people face pain, loneliness, and difficulties. It can bring happiness, peace, and emotional strength to life.

Poets compose poems for their beloved because normal words are often not enough to express deep feelings. Poetry allows poets to use ~~a~~ beautiful language, images, and rhythm to share their love. Writing poems also helps poets keep their emotions alive and meaningful. Through poetry, they can express promises, memories, joy and even pain of separation.

Poems written for loved ones become special because they come from the heart. They help the beloved feel valued and respected. That is why love is considered powerful. ~~a~~ and poetry is a natural way to express it.

c. Poetry is the expression of feeling and emotions. Explain.

Ans. Poetry is called the expression of feelings and emotions because it helps people share what they feel inside their hearts. Feelings like love, sadness, happiness, fear and hope are sometimes hard to explain in simple words. Poetry gives a beautiful way to express these emotions clearly and deeply.

Poets use special words, rhythm, Images, and figures of speech to make their feelings strong and meaningful. When a poet feels pain, love or joy, he or she puts those emotions into a poem. When people read poems, they can feel the emotions of the poet and connect with them.

Poetry does not only tell a story; it shows emotions and moods. It touches the reader's heart and makes them think and feel. That is why poetry is called the language of emotions and a powerful form of human expression.